

- Second-degree burns damage the epidermis and the layer beneath it (called the dermis).
- Third-degree burns involve damage or complete destruction of the skin to its full depth and damage to underlying tissues also. People who experience such burns often require skin grafting.

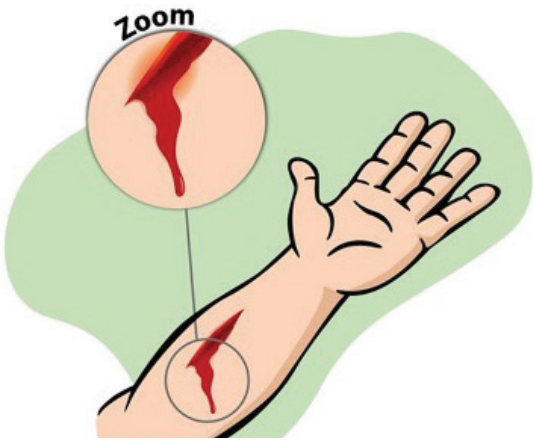


First aid for Burning

In case of minor burns, the affected area should be washed with cold water and an antiseptic cream should be applied. In case of severe burns, where deeper layers of tissues get destroyed and blisters appear, use of water should be avoided. The burnt area should be covered with a clean non-sticking cloth or bandages. Larger burns need immediate medical attention. It is very important to keep a fire extinguisher readily available.

6.5.2 Cut and Scratches

Cuts and scratches are the areas of damage on the surface of the skin. A cut is a line of damage that can go through the skin and into the muscle tissues below, whereas a scratch is surface damage that does not penetrate the lower tissues. Cuts and scratches may bleed or turn red, become infected and leave scars.



First aid for cuts

For minor cuts, the affected area should be washed with cold running water and cleaned with an antiseptic liquid. Then an antiseptic cream should be applied on the wound and sterilized bandage should be tied to prevent infection. If the cut is deep, a clean cotton pad should be placed on the cut and pressed, and the injured person should be taken to a doctor immediately.



6.6 Basic cleanliness and protection

The most important thing is to help anybody, but you must also protect yourself from HIV and other blood-borne diseases